

EYE ON THE GOAL
CM Yogi at the closing ceremony of a hockey tournament in Lucknow, Apr. 4

ON THE CM'S TO-DO LIST

- Attract Rs 10 lakh crore investment in the upcoming investor summit
- Ensure payment of Rs 8,000 crore for sugarcane within 100 days and Rs 12,000 crore in six months
- Establish a cow sanctuary. At least 50,000 cows to be rehabilitated through coordination with the panchayati raj department
- All service selection boards to provide government jobs to 10,000 youths in the state
- Set up three Mahila Battalions in the UP police to improve women's safety

murder took place there on September 28 last year.

The 'fear of Yogi' also apparently had Gautam Singh, a history-sheeter involved in several cases of kidnapping and extortion, surrendering at the Chapla police station in Gonda on March 15, a few days after the BJP's win in the state. Over two dozen criminals surrendered the same day in Saharanpur too. Liquor smugglers have done so in Deoband and Shamli. In Pratapgarh, a rape accused gave himself up days after he allegedly committed the crime. The police parked a bulldozer outside his house and had threatened to raze it if he didn't surrender.

"In the past two and a half years," says Prashant Kumar, ADG, law & order, UP, "property worth Rs 2,000 crore owned by the mafia and other criminal elements has been seized or demolished. Most of UP's top criminals are in jail. In the next 100 days, we will identify more criminals involved in organised crime."

To allay any misapprehension of the bulldozer becoming a symbol of oppression, Kumar adds, "Instructions have come that bulldozers should not be misused. They have been used to demolish illegal constructions, including on government properties. All judicial processes are completed before demolition."

The opposition, though, is unconvinced. Yogi's preoccupation with the bulldozer, says Samajwadi Party chief Akhilesh Yadav, is pushing the state into anarchy and jungle raj. "With his hand on the bulldozer steering, the CM is chasing the Opposition while criminals, protected by the powers that be, are wreaking havoc."

Unperturbed by the criticism, Yogi is thinking of